

If you're going to keep responding to reviews yourself, use these.

These three patterns are built specifically to stay safe under HIPAA in the situations that come up most — a positive review, a negative review with a clinical complaint, and a review that might not even be from a real patient. Each one is written to never confirm or deny a treatment relationship, which is the actual line HIPAA draws.

TIER 1

Responding to a positive review

"Thank you for the kind words! We're glad to hear it. If you ever have questions about your care, our office is always happy to help — feel free to call us directly at [Phone]."

Why it's safe: thanks the reviewer for leaving a review, not for being a patient — it works exactly the same regardless of who they actually are.

TIER 2

Responding to a negative review with a clinical complaint

"We take all feedback seriously, as patient care is our highest priority. Due to privacy regulations, we can't discuss specific care details in a public forum. Please contact our Practice Manager at [Phone] so we can look into this directly."

Why it's safe: speaks only in general policy terms and moves the conversation offline — never confirms or denies a treatment relationship.

TIER 3

Responding to a review that might not even be a real patient

"We take every review seriously and want to make things right wherever possible. If you'd like to discuss this further, please reach out to us directly at [Phone] so we can look into it."

Why it's safe: stays completely neutral on patient status either way.

Never say anything like "we have no record of you" or "you're not a patient of ours." Denying someone's patient status is itself a HIPAA disclosure — just like confirming it would be.

These work, but they're the same three lines for every review — read enough of them and it shows. RespondPal writes a fresh, on-brand response for every single review, still fully HIPAA-compliant, so it never reads like a template.